

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs uzma shirwani

Address: 4 Heyward Court Overton Road Sutton SM2 6JY

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I strongly support Application DM2025/01591

I have lived in this area for 31 years, and in this time I have seen very few establishments that allow for the community to come together, meet each other and get to know one another.

This is not just about a building, number of people, or parking spaces. It is about the community.

I see the former ambulance site as an ideal location for a community centre that could host free health check sessions for residents, mother and toddler groups for young parents, and structured activities for young people, particularly as there is currently no dedicated youth centre in the surrounding area.

Through BASMA's existing activities such as weekly Friday prayers, monthly talks, community dinners during Ramadan, and sports sessions for both men and women, strong friendships have formed and a welcoming and inclusive local network has developed among people who previously did not know one another. A permanent community centre would allow this positive work to continue in a more organised and accessible setting.

These activities reflect a genuine commitment to supporting all parts of the community including elders, young people and families. Programmes such as women's wellbeing sessions, children's activities and family-focused events are designed to provide a safe and supportive environment for local residents.

Importantly, the proposed centre would also include a publicly accessible defibrillator on site. This would be available for use in medical emergencies and would provide an additional community health resource for the surrounding neighbourhood.

I also wish to reassure local neighbours and the nearby primary school that the centre would offer positive facilities for the community. It would be a place where young people can take part in structured activities, women can attend fitness sessions, and older residents can enjoy social gatherings such as coffee mornings.

The former ambulance station operated on a twenty-four-hour basis, with emergency vehicles regularly arriving and leaving. A community hub would not operate around the clock and would not involve constant vehicle movement, resulting in significantly less disturbance to neighbouring residents.

Moreover, the site would only approach its maximum capacity of 250 during the Friday congregational prayer. At other times of the day, attendance for regular activities and daily prayers would be significantly lower. This indicates that demand on parking would be limited for the majority of the week and that there would not be continuous levels of noise or activity during daytime hours.

There are also convenient bus routes in the area, and many local members would be able to walk to the centre.

Overall, I believe this centre would have a positive impact on the wider community, and I hope the council will view this application as a constructive step for the future.

I kindly ask that this application be approved.

Kind regards,
Uzma Shirwani